



Soft Tissue Graft

Purpose: Transplanting gum tissue to cover exposed roots, thicken thin gums, or improve aesthetics.

First 24 Hours:

- Avoid pulling on your lip to view the surgical site.
- Do not rinse, spit, or use a straw.
- Keep head elevated when resting.

Pain & Swelling:

- Mild discomfort is normal; take prescribed or OTC pain relievers as directed.
- Apply ice packs to the face for 20 minutes on/off for the first 6–8 hours.

Bleeding:

- Slight bleeding or oozing is normal for the first 24–48 hours.
- Apply gentle pressure with moist gauze if needed.

Oral Hygiene:

- Do not brush or floss the graft site until cleared by your dentist.
- Use prescribed antimicrobial mouth rinse as directed.
- Brush and floss other areas normally.

Diet:

- Soft, cool foods for 1–2 weeks.
- Avoid spicy, crunchy, or hot foods that could irritate the graft.

Special Precautions:

- Avoid strenuous activity for 48 hours.
- Do not smoke, as it delays healing.

Follow-Up:

- Stitches may dissolve or require removal in 1–2 weeks.
- Contact the office if the graft appears loose, there is excessive bleeding, or pain increases after day 3.